

The Best is Yet to Come

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[A NOTE FOR YOU, THE PREACHER]

- Night 9: The Best is Yet to Come
- Special instructions: For this sermon, there are several suggestions that the pastor can evaluate:
 - If there is a baptistery in the church and the pastor is present, the baptismal ceremony must take place in the morning. In this case, the Sabbath school program should be shorter than usual because the sermon is followed by a baptismal service.
 - If the pastor cannot be present in the morning, the first elder should make a clear announcement about the time the ceremony will be held after lunch or early in the afternoon—not next Sabbath!
 - Those who are willing and committed to be baptized this morning, should receive instruction during the Sabbath School about the baptismal ceremony.
 - If candidates are to be voted today by the Church, it should be done during the announcements before the sermon.
 - Candidates must have a reserved area in the front pews, where they can sit together during the sermon.
- The preacher must be ready to provide the following information:
 - Opening song: #165 “Vendrá el Señor!” (“We Know Not the Hour”).
 - Scripture reading: Apocalipsis 21:1-4 (Revelation 21:1-4).
 - Title of the sermon: “Lo Mejor Está por Venir” (“The Best Is Yet to Come”).
 - Closing hymn: We will sing “Que mi vida entera esté,” #248 (#259 in the Old Hymnal).
- Candidates should receive instructions related to the ceremony during the Sabbath School, possibly in a separate room. Candidates should get ready for the baptism during the sermon. Others may come forward at the end of the sermon. During the announcements another invitation is made so that other candidates will be ready for the ceremony during the sermon.
- Final appeal at the end of the sermon: “I know that there are some here that they have attended church for a long time, but that they have never made the decision to be baptized. I invite you to come to the front. Maybe a friend can accompany you to the front. Please come.”
- The closing hymn should be sung the way the church does every Sabbath, either with piano, PowerPoint, etc. During the song, the preacher may use the microphone to invite people to come forward. Some candidates are already waiting to be baptized. Others may come forward during the hymn. During the hymn, the pastor will enter the baptistery, so the ceremony will begin immediately, without delay. For someone who decided to be baptized at this time who and was not on the list, deacons

must be prepared with baptismal clothes and towels.

- After the baptismal ceremony, the pastor should make a call from the water to those who have not been baptized and announce that there will be another baptismal ceremony right after the meal, if necessary. The pastor offers the closing prayer, perhaps from the water. Candidates should be invited to form a line by the door to receive greetings from church members.
- Preachers will not return to the church in the afternoon. This means that you should greet members for the last time. They will miss you! Make sure that you don't forget anything.
- Get ready for a last meeting in the evening with the Conference leaders and pastors, possibly at the hotel.

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- This morning, I will share with you one of my favorite subjects: The Best is Yet to Come!

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- During the week, we have learned about how to have a new beginning with Christ.
- We have learned about how Christ can make a difference in our lives.
- When we receive Jesus and His gift of salvation, we receive a new life.

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- This morning, for our final message, we will learn about the new beginning that God will bring to our planet.
- We will learn about how God will restore all things.
- Together, we will study one of the most precious promises of Scripture: the promise that Jesus will come again and make everything new.

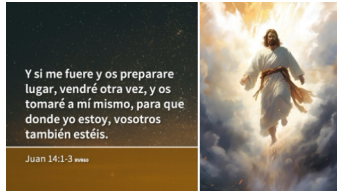
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- The promise of Jesus is recorded in John 14:1-3, "Let not your heart be troubled; you believe in God, believe also in Me. In My Father's house are many mansions; if it were not so, I would have told you. I go to prepare a place for you."

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- And if I go and prepare a place for you, I will come again and receive you to Myself; that where I am, there you may be also.

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- The promise of Jesus is very clear: “I will come again.”
- There is no doubt or uncertainty in His words.
- Jesus never lies; He always keeps His promises.
- We can be certain that Jesus will come again.

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- However, Jesus warned His disciples about false Christs.
- Even today there are many deceptions about the return of Jesus.
- In fact, Satan desires to “deceive the whole world” (Rev. 12:9).
- It would be no surprise if he himself appears as a false Christ.

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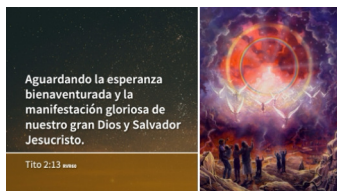
- But God gives us the truth in His Word.
- Scripture is clear about the manner in which Jesus will come back.
- Let’s take some time to study the truths in the Bible about the coming of Christ.

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- FACT #1: Christ’s coming will be a literal event.

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- Titus 2:13 says that as Christians we are “looking for the blessed hope and glorious appearing of our great God and Savior Jesus Christ.”

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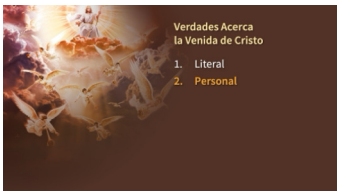
- The Second Coming will be real, just like Creation.
- It will be real, just like the first coming of Christ.
- We do not hope in a vague idea; our blessed hope will be an actual reality.

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- Our world is filled with problems, but we have hope.
- Our lives are filled with problems, but we have hope.
- Jesus can give us a new beginning, and He will give this world a new beginning as well.

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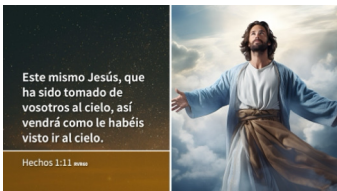
- FACT #2: Christ's coming will be a personal event.

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- Several weeks after Jesus resurrected from death, the disciples watched Him ascend to heaven.
- They had spent three and a half years following Him. They saw Him die. They saw Him after His resurrection. Now He was gone.

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- But they received a special promise.
- Two angels were standing nearby.
- Listen to their words of encouragement in Acts 1:11: "This Jesus, who has been taken up from you into heaven, will come in just the same way as you have watched Him go into heaven."

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- The same Jesus who was born in Bethlehem,
- who died on the cross,
- who rose from the dead,
- who stands in the presence of the Father...
- this same Jesus will come back!

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- FACT #3: Christ's coming will be a visible event.

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- Revelation 1:7 declares: "Behold, He is coming with clouds, and every eye will see Him."

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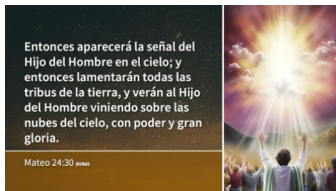
- From every country, from every part of the earth, the rich, the poor, the young, and the old—everyone will see Jesus when He comes back.

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- Jesus will come back with millions of angels. The earth will be surrounded by these hosts of angels. Everyone will see it! No one will miss it.

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- Matthew 24:30 also says, "Then the sign of the Son of Man will appear in heaven, and then all the tribes of the earth will mourn, and they will see the Son of Man coming on the clouds of heaven with power and great glory."
- This will not be a secret. All the nations will see Him.

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- When Christ came the first time, only a few shepherds welcomed Him.

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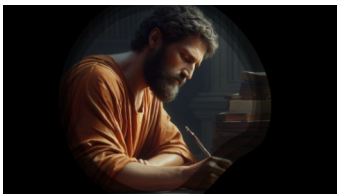
- But when Jesus comes the second time, every eye will see Him. Everyone will recognize Him as the King of Kings.

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- FACT #4: Christ's coming will be an audible event.

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- One of the most glorious descriptions of the return of Jesus is found in the writings of Paul.
- Paul was encouraging some believers who had lost friends and family in death.
- They wanted to know if their loved ones would see Jesus come.
- Under inspiration, Paul gave them the certainty that Jesus will resurrect the dead.
- Listen to his powerful description of the return of Jesus:

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- “For the Lord himself will descend from heaven with a cry of command, with the voice of an archangel, and with the sound of the trumpet of God. And the dead in Christ will rise first.”

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- What a marvelous event! Notice the words that describe sound: “command,” “voice of an archangel,” and “trumpet.” Just as every eye will see Him, every ear will hear Him. Even the dead in Christ will hear His command, and they will come out of their graves!

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- We all have experienced the loss of a loved one.
- We all have experienced the sorrow that this separation brings.
- But one day soon, sorrow will end.
- One day soon, death will no longer exist.

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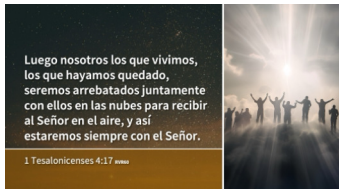
- One day soon, Jesus will come.
- The trumpet will sound. The hosts of angels will sing.
- The King of the Universe will command the dead to come out from their graves, and they will hear His voice.

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- Do you have sorrow? Is there pain in your heart?
- Are you missing a father, a mother, a brother, a sister, a child?
- Has death separated you from a loved one?
- Tonight, I want to encourage you.
- The Bible gives us promises of hope and comfort.
- If your loved one has died in Christ, you will see them again.
- You will hear their voice. You will see their smile. You will feel their embrace.
- They will hear the command of Christ, and they will rise from their graves.
- We will be united again with our loved ones on that glorious day.

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- Scripture assures us: “Then we who are alive, who are left, will be caught up together with them in the clouds to meet the Lord in the air, and so we will always be with the Lord.” –1 Thess. 4:17.

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- When Christ comes, every eye will see Him; every ear will hear Him.
- Christ will give the command, the trumpet will sound, and the dead will rise.
- But something else will happen when the trumpet sounds.
- The Bible says that our bodies will be transformed.

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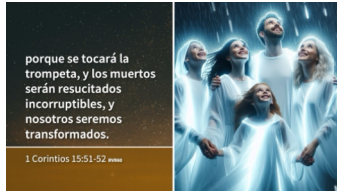


- Paul writes that this will happen “in a moment, in the twinkling of an eye, at the last trumpet.

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- For the trumpet will sound, and the dead will be raised incorruptible, and we shall be changed.

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- If you are suffering from a disease,
- if you are dealing with sickness,
- if you struggle with physical pain,
- you have the hope that one day your body will be transformed. “We shall be changed.”
- Every eye will see Him. Every ear will hear the voice of the trumpet. The dead in Christ will rise. We shall all be changed.

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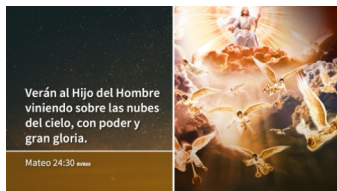
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- FACT #5: Christ’s coming will be a glorious event.

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- Scripture says in Matthew 24:30 that “they will see the Son of Man coming on the clouds of heaven with power and great glory.”

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- In His first coming to earth, Jesus came as a humble baby. He grew up and looked like a normal human being. He did not come to establish a political kingdom. He came to win the hearts of people.

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- But when Jesus comes the second time, everyone will recognize that He is the King of Kings. He will come with divine glory and multitudes of angels.

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- On the day of His crucifixion, He wore a crown of thorns. But one day soon, He will return with a crown of glory.

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- FACT #6: Christ's coming is imminent.
- The word imminent refers to something that is near or about to happen.

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- In the last week before Jesus died, He gave His disciples a list of signs that indicate when His coming is near. These signs include wars, famines, natural disasters, persecution, and more. These signs are increasing in frequency and intensity.

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- Jesus told his disciples, "When you see all these things, know that it is near—at the doors!" –Matt. 24:33.

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- We do not know how much longer the history of this earth will continue. We do not know how much time we have left. But the signs are telling us that Jesus is coming soon.

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- FACT #7: Christ's coming will be decisive.
- There will be two groups of people when Jesus comes back:
- Those who accepted Jesus as their Savior and Lord,
- And those who rejected Jesus' authority and forgiveness.

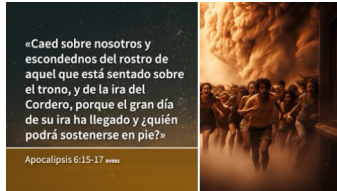
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- In vision, the apostle John saw the return of Jesus and the terror of those who rejected Him.
- He says that they “hid themselves in the caves and in the rocks of the mountains, and said to the mountains and rocks,

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- ‘Fall on us and hide us from the face of Him who sits on the throne and from the wrath of the Lamb! For the great day of His wrath has come, and who is able to stand?’” –Rev. 6:15-17.

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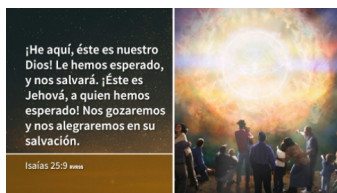
- How sad it is that there will be people who hide from the face of the one who died to save them!
- Those who have rejected the authority and forgiveness of God will one day face His justice.
- They will be destroyed “by the brightness of His coming” (2 Thess. 2:9).

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- But there will be another group of people.
- These individuals have surrendered their lives to Jesus.
- They have accepted Jesus as their Savior and Lord.
- When He comes back, they receive Him with joy.

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- They will look up into the sky and proclaim:
- “This is our God; we have waited for Him, and He will save us. This is the LORD; we have waited for Him; we will be glad and rejoice in His salvation.” –Isa. 25:9.
- Instead of hiding from Jesus, they will welcome Him with joy.
- For them, He has not come to judge, but rather to save.
- These are the ones who put Jesus first, who accept His forgiveness, who surrender their lives to Jesus, who receive power to keep His commandments; they trust in Jesus for everything.
- I want to be a part of this group, how about you?

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- Jesus promised to take us to be with Him.
- The Bible says that after the resurrection when Jesus comes back, we will go to heaven and live with Christ for a thousand years.

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“...les ha preparado una ciudad.” —Hebreos 11:16.

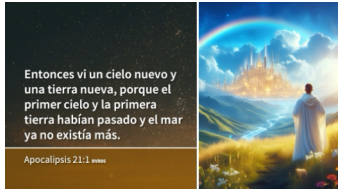
- God has prepared many wonderful things for those who love Him.
- Hebrews 11:16 says that “He has prepared a city for them.”
- We find a description of this city in the Book of Revelation. It is a real place.

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- The Bible says that after one thousand years in heaven, Jesus will return to earth with His people.
- The New Jerusalem will descend from heaven.
- God will recreate this earth, and the New Jerusalem will be the capital city.

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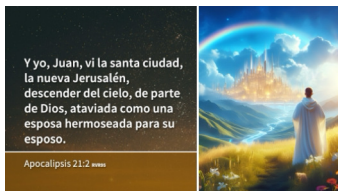


Entonces vi un cielo nuevo y una tierra nueva, porque el primer cielo y la primera tierra habían pasado y el mar ya no existía más.

Apocalipsis 21:1

- In Revelation 21:1-2, we read: “Now I saw a new heaven and a new earth, for the first heaven and the first earth had passed away. Also, there was no more sea.

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Y yo, Juan, vi la santa ciudad, la nueva Jerusalén, descender del cielo, de parte de Dios, ataviada como una esposa hermoseada para su esposo.

Apocalipsis 21:2

- Then I, John, saw the holy city, New Jerusalem, coming down out of heaven from God, prepared as a bride adorned for her husband.”

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- On this planet, where rebellion has continued for thousands of years—
- On this planet, where Jesus lived and died—
- On this planet, where the war between good and evil comes to an end—
- On this planet God will establish the capital city of the universe.

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- No notes

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- One of the greatest joys in the Garden of Eden was that God was there.
- He walked and talked with Adam and Eve.
- But sin separated human beings from God.
- They could no longer see the face of God because God's visible presence destroys sin and sinners.
- But even though there is a separation, God still desires to be with His people.

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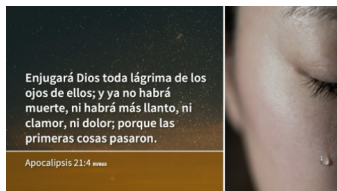
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- One day soon, that will be a reality.
- One day soon, God will dwell with His people.
- One day soon, there will be no more separation between us and God. We will be together—forever.

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- On that day, there will be no more sadness, no more suffering.
- “And God will wipe away every tear from their eyes; there shall be no more death, nor sorrow, nor crying. There shall be no more pain, for the former things have passed away.” –Rev. 21:4.

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- The natural world will be transformed.
- Animals that are violent today will be peaceful and calm in the new earth.

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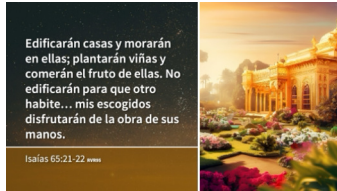
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- We will not be bored in the new earth. We will participate in real activities.

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- The Bible says in Isaiah 65:21-23, "They will build houses and dwell in them; plant vineyards and eat their fruit. Not build and another inhabit... My chosen shall long enjoy the work of their hands."

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- We will be able to fly to other galaxies.
- We will be able to travel throughout the universe.
- We will testify to other created beings about Jesus and His love.
- We will talk with God's people from all throughout history.
- And each Sabbath, we will gather together for worship.

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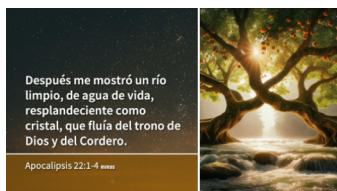
- God says in Isaiah 66:23, "from month to month and from one Sabbath to another, all mankind will come to worship before me," says the Lord."
- The law of God is eternal, and we will continue meeting weekly on the seventh day.

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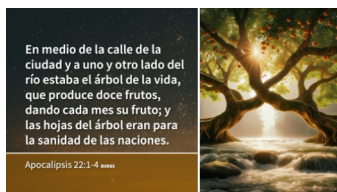
- The Bible describes what life will be like in the capital city of the new earth: the New Jerusalem.
- Turn with me in your Bibles to our last text: Revelation 22:1-4.

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- Revelation 22:1-4 says: "And he showed me a pure river of water of life, clear as crystal, flowing from the throne of God and of the Lamb.

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- "In the midst of the street of the city, and to the side and across the river, was the tree of life, which bore twelve fruits, giving her fruit every month; The leaves of the tree were for the healing of the nations."
- Remember Isaiah said that from month to month and from one Sabbath to the next!
- Every month when we eat from the tree of life, we will join to give thanks to God for saving us.

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- “And there will be no more curse; and the throne of God and of the Lamb shall be in it, and his servants shall serve him; “they shall see His face, and His name shall be in their foreheads.”

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- Brothers and sisters, I hope we can be together on the day when we will finally see His face.
- I hope we can eat together from the tree of life.
- I hope we can worship Jesus together in the New Jerusalem.
- I hope we can serve Jesus together in the New Earth.

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- Today is the last day of our series, “A New Beginning.”
- We have made precious memories together.
- We have sung together.
- We have studied the Word of God together.
- I will miss you all.
- But I am glad that we have a precious hope in Jesus!
- If we belong to Jesus, we will see each other again in the New Jerusalem and in the New Earth.

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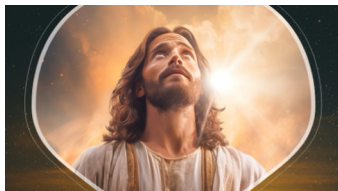
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- There is nothing on earth that is more important than knowing Jesus and being ready for His return.
- There is nothing on earth that is more important than preparing for eternity.

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- How is your relationship with Jesus?
- He died for you. He paid the price for your forgiveness.
- He gave everything so that you can live with Him forever.
- He loves you with an everlasting love.
- Have you said “yes” to Jesus? Have you accepted His sacrifice?
- Is He the Lord of your life? Do you put Him first in everything?
- If you have not surrendered your life to Jesus, please do so today.
- If this morning you realize that your focus is not on Jesus, choose now to put Him first.
- Today is the day of salvation. If you hear Him calling you to be baptized, please do not delay.

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- Jesus is coming soon. Very soon He will create a new heaven and a new earth.
- You can be a part of that glorious reality.
- If you want to join me in surrendering to Jesus, stand with me as we pray.
- (Appeal by raising hands or an altar call as the Spirit leads.)